



USER GUIDE • SEPTEMBER 2026

LE OSINT Framework Investigation Desk

How to use the open-source intelligence desk for law enforcement: searching selectors, following playbooks, building suspect profiles, looking up ports and HS codes, and recording evidence.

696

free sources in 50
categories

206

searches that fill in your
selector

3,802

commercial seaports +
14,700 port codes

6,939

HS codes with risk labels

What is in this guide

- 1 What the framework is and who it is for
- 2 Opening the framework: online, on your laptop, from GitHub
- 3 The screen at a glance
- 4 The search bar and run sheets
- 5 Flow chart and web map
- 6 Source list, lines of enquiry and flags
- 7 World ports and UN/LOCODE codes
- 8 HS code finder
- 9 Case playbooks
- 10 Suspect profile
- 11 Toolbox and case log
- 12 Operational security, legal and evidential rules
- 13 Sharing, updating and maintaining the framework
- 14 Troubleshooting and frequently asked questions
- A Appendix: flags, selector types and quick reference

In one minute

Paste what you have about a subject into the search bar (a name, phone number, email, container number, wallet...). The framework recognises what it is and gives you a **run sheet**: every free source that can search it, already filled in, grouped by line of enquiry. Open the searches, tick them off, log what matters to the case log, and export the log to your case file.

What the framework is and who it is for

A single page that brings together the free open-source intelligence (OSINT) resources an investigator needs, organised the way an investigation runs.

The LE OSINT Framework is a web page that works in any modern browser (Edge, Chrome, Firefox, Safari). It needs no installation, no account and no server. It was built for police, customs and border officers, analysts and trainers who carry out open-source research as part of an authorised investigation.

What it contains

PART	WHAT IT DOES
696 free sources	Search engines, social networks, company and court registers, maritime and aviation trackers, blockchain explorers, sanctions lists, law-enforcement request portals and more, in 50 categories. No paid services are listed.
Search bar and run sheets	Recognises the type of selector you paste and lists the 206 searches that accept it, already filled in.
Flow chart and web map	Two visual maps of every source, organised by line of enquiry.
World ports	3,802 commercial seaports (NGA World Port Index) plus 14,700 more UN/LOCODE port codes, searchable by country, name or code.
HS codes	All 6,939 Harmonized System codes (HS 2022), searchable, with labels for drug precursors, narcotics, arms, excise goods, frequent cover loads, high-value goods and medicines.
Case playbooks	Step-by-step guides for eight common case types, each step linked to the right sources.
Suspect profile	Enter what you know about a person; get targeted searches, intelligence gaps, a findings log and a report.
Toolbox and case log	Offline tools (hashing, EXIF, check-digit validators, phone and IMEI analyser, coordinates, crypto address identifier, dork builder, time converter, encoder) and a timestamped case log.

How it is organised: lines of enquiry

Instead of one long alphabetical list, sources are grouped by the question you are trying to answer:

LINE OF ENQUIRY	QUESTION IT ANSWERS
Person	Who is this person? (usernames, email, phone, social media, people search, public records, identity documents, wanted persons)
Communications	Who are they talking to, and where? (messaging, gaming, telecom, forums, dark web, terrorism)
Goods, travel & transport	Where is the shipment, vessel, vehicle or traveller? (maritime, customs, vehicles, aviation, drugs, classifieds, firearms and wildlife)

Money & companies	Where is the money and who owns what? (company registers, fraud, crypto, sanctions)
Digital infrastructure	What is behind this website, IP address or file?
Places & media	Where and when was this photo or video taken?
By country	National registers, gazettes, courts, wanted lists and marketplaces for 24 countries.
General research	Search engines, archives, translation, decoding, tools.
Procedure & reporting	Law-enforcement request portals, cooperation, legal frameworks, OpSec, evidence capture, training.

Important

The framework only links to third-party websites. It does not search them for you in the background and it stores nothing on any server. Your legal authority, your agency's policy and the principles of necessity and proportionality decide what you may search, not the availability of a link.

Opening the framework

There are three ways to use it. All three show exactly the same tool.

A. Online (recommended for most users)

Open <https://glretief-ux.github.io/LE-OSINT-Framework/> in your browser and bookmark it. The online version always shows the latest update. Some agency networks block GitHub; if so, use option B.

B. Offline on your laptop (one file)

- 1 Get **LE-OSINT-Framework.zip** (by email or from the repository: `dist/le-osint-framework.html`).
- 2 Right-click the zip → **Extract All**. Save the HTML file somewhere permanent, e.g. `Documents\OSINT\`.
- 3 Double-click the file. It opens in your default browser.
- 4 Optional: press `Ctrl + D` to bookmark it, or right-click the file → **Send to → Desktop (create shortcut)**.

Everything in the tool works without internet (maps, lists, ports, HS codes, toolbox, case log). You only need a connection to open the external websites themselves. The single file can also be carried on a USB stick to a standalone research computer if your policy allows local HTML files.

C. From the GitHub repository

The source is at github.com/glretief-ux/LE-OSINT-Framework. Administrators use it to update the source list, run the weekly link check and publish the online version (see chapter 13).

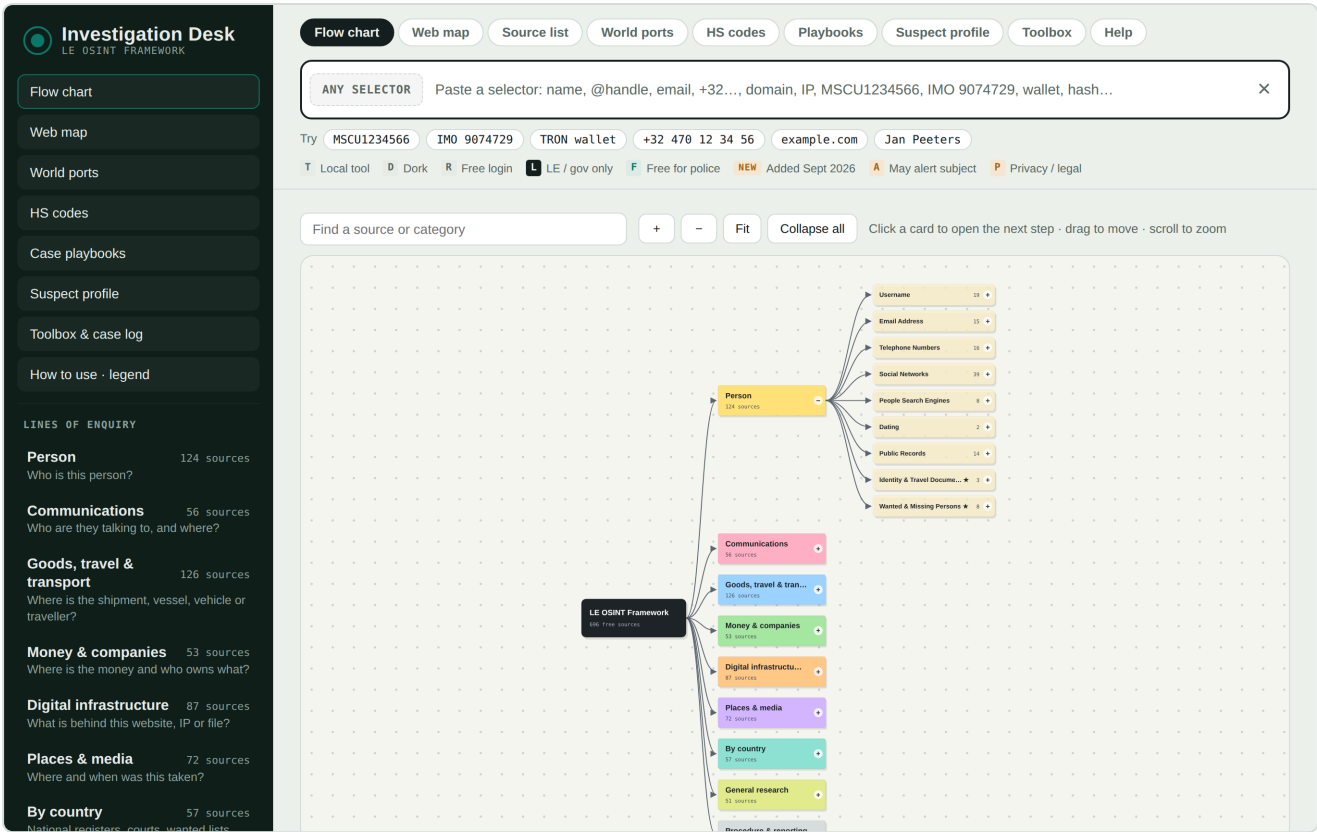
Keeping your laptop copy current

When a new version is released, replace your saved HTML file with the new one. Export your case log first (Toolbox → Case log → Export CSV); the log is kept in your browser, not in the file, so it normally survives the swap, but an export is your safeguard.

Supported browsers and screens

Any current version of Microsoft Edge, Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox or Apple Safari. The page adapts to laptop, tablet and phone screens; the visual maps are easiest to use on a laptop or larger screen.

The screen at a glance



The opening screen: side panel on the left, section menu and search bar at the top, the flow chart below.

AREA	USE
Section menu (top)	Flow chart · Web map · Source list · World ports · HS codes · Playbooks · Suspect profile · Toolbox · Help. The dark button is the section you are in.
Search bar	Paste any selector. The chip on the left shows what type it recognised. See chapter 4.
Try examples	Click one to see how a container number, IMO number, wallet, phone number, domain or name is handled.
Flag legend	Explains the small letters shown next to sources (full list in the appendix).
Side panel (left)	The same section buttons, then the nine lines of enquiry with the number of sources in each. When a selector is entered, each line shows how many searches it holds for that selector.

On a phone or narrow screen the side panel moves to the top and the lines of enquiry scroll sideways.

The search bar and run sheets

The fastest way to work: paste a selector and get a checklist of every search that applies.

Step by step

- 1 Click in the search bar and paste or type a selector, for example MSCU1234566, +32 470 12 34 56, jan.peeters88@gmail.com or Jan Peeters.
- 2 Check the chip on the left of the bar. It shows the recognised type, e.g. **CONTAINER NO.** If it is wrong, click the chip and choose the correct type (a pencil mark shows you overrode it).
- 3 Press **Enter** (or open **Source list**) to see the **run sheet**.
- 4 Click a search to open it in a new tab. It is ticked off automatically; the progress bar shows how many you have done.
- 5 Click **Log** next to a search to record it in the case log with the UTC time.
- 6 Click **Copy run sheet** to paste the full list (ticked / not ticked, with links) into your report.

The screenshot shows the 'Investigation Desk' interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: Flow chart, Web map, World ports, HS codes, Case playbooks, Suspect profile, Toolbox & case log, and How to use - legend. Below these are 'LINES OF ENQUIRY' categories: Person (12 searches), Communications (1 search), Goods, travel & transport, Money & companies (9 searches), Digital infrastructure (1 search), Places & media (4 searches), and By country (8 searches). The main area displays the 'Source list' for 'Jan Peeters'. At the top, there's a search bar with 'PERSON NAME Jan Peeters' and a list of selectors: MSCU1234566, IMO 9074729, TRON wallet, +32 470 12 34 56, example.com, and Jan Peeters. Below the selectors are icons for 'Local tool', 'Dork', 'Free login', 'LE / gov only', 'Free for police', 'NEW Added Sept 2026', 'May alert subject', and 'Privacy / legal'. The 'RUN SHEET' for 'PERSON NAME Jan Peeters' shows a progress bar at '2 of 49 checked' and buttons for 'Copy run sheet' and 'Reset ticks'. A tip suggests 'Generate username and email variants in the Toolbox -->'. The 'Person' section asks 'Who is this person?' and lists search engines under 'SOCIAL NETWORKS', 'PEOPLE SEARCH ENGINES', 'DATING', and 'PUBLIC RECORDS'. Each search engine has a checkbox, a 'PREFILLED' status, and a 'Log' button. The 'SOCIAL NETWORKS' section includes Google social dork, Facebook Search, X Search (latest), TikTok Search, LinkedIn Search, Google LinkedIn dork (no alert), YouTube Search, and Bluesky Search. The 'PEOPLE SEARCH ENGINES' section includes Webmii. The 'DATING' section includes Google dating profile dork. The 'PUBLIC RECORDS' section includes CourtListener (US).

Run sheet for a person's name: 42 searches grouped by line of enquiry, two already ticked.

What the search bar recognises

TYPE	EXAMPLE	NOTES
Container number	MSCU1234566	ISO 6346: 3-letter owner code + U/I/Z + 7 digits.
IMO number	IMO 9074729	7 digits with a valid check digit, with or without "IMO".

MMSI	353136000	9 digits.
Phone number	+32 470 12 34 56	Use the international format; spaces and dashes are removed automatically.
Email address	name@example.com	
Username	@jp_kiel or jp_kiel	A single word without spaces is treated as a username.
Person name	Jan Peeters	Two or more words. Choose Company from the chip for a business name.
Domain / URL / IP / MAC	example.com, https://..., 8.8.8.8	An image URL (ending .jpg, .png...) is treated as an image for reverse search.
Crypto address	TR7NHqje..., 0x..., bc1...	Bitcoin, Ethereum/EVM and TRON formats.
File hash	32, 40 or 64 hex characters	MD5, SHA-1 or SHA-256.
VIN / aircraft registration / CVE	1HGCM82633A004352, 00-SNA, CVE-2024-3094	

Tip: the selector follows you

Once a selector is entered, sources that accept it are highlighted everywhere: green outlines in the flow chart, green dots in the web map and a "prefilled" label in the source list. Clear the bar with the **x** button or **Esc**.

The screenshot shows the Investigation Desk interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with tabs: Flow chart, Web map, Source list (selected), World ports, HS codes, Playbooks, Suspect profile, Toolbox, and Help. Below this is a search bar with the text 'CONTAINER NO. MSCU1234566'. Under the search bar, there's a row of sources: Try MSCU1234566, IMO 9074729, TRON wallet, +32 470 12 34 56, example.com, and Jan Peeters. Below this is a row of filters: T Local tool, D Disk, R Free login, L LE / gov only, F Free for police, NEW Added Sept 2026, A May alert subject, and P Privacy / legal. The main content area is titled 'RUN SHEET · CONTAINER NO. MSCU1234566' and shows '0 of 4 checked' with buttons for 'Copy run sheet' and 'Reset ticks'. A tip says 'Tip: Validate the ISO 6346 check digit first in the Toolbox ...'. Below this is a section 'Goods, travel & transport' with the question 'Where is the shipment, vessel, vehicle or traveller?'. Under 'MARITIME & CONTAINERS', there are four options: SeaRates Tracking (prefilled), Google (exact container / vessel / IMO) (prefilled), Maersk (prefilled), and ONE (prefilled). Each option has a 'Log' button. The sidebar on the left has a 'LINES OF ENQUIRY' section with categories: Person (Who is this person?), Communications (Who are they talking to, and where?), Goods, travel & transport (4 searches, Where is the shipment, vessel, vehicle or traveller?), Money & companies (Where is the money and who owns what?), Digital infrastructure (What is behind this website, IP or file?), Places & media (Where and when was this taken?), and By country (A list of countries, sorted first).

A container number gives carrier tracking searches, plus a tip to validate the check digit first.

CHAPTER 5

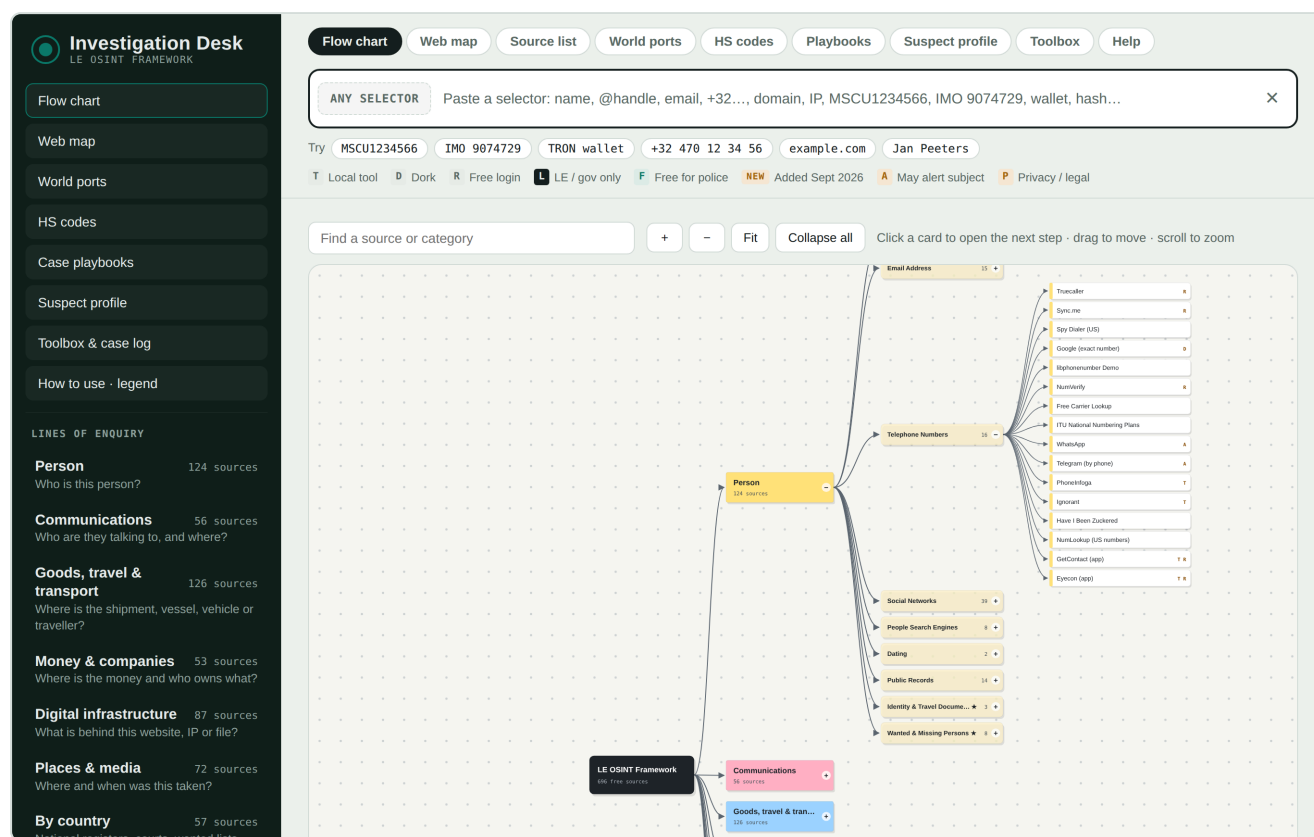
Flow chart and web map

Two ways to see all sources at once and browse without a selector.

Flow chart (opening screen)

A left-to-right board of sticky notes, like Mural or a whiteboard. The dark card on the left is the hub; the coloured notes are the nine lines of enquiry.

- **Click a coloured note** to open its categories. **Click a category** to open its sources. The + / - on each note shows whether it is open.
- **Click a white source card** to open the website in a new tab. Hover over it to see what it is for, where it sits and what its flags mean.
- ★ marks the categories added specifically for law enforcement.
- **Find box:** type a word such as "vessel" or "telegram"; matching notes open and are outlined in orange.
- **Move around:** drag the board, scroll or use + / - to zoom, **Fit** to see everything, **Collapse all** to start again.



Flow chart with Person and Telephone Numbers opened.

Web map

The same sources drawn as a spider web around a central hub. Click a line of enquiry to spin out its categories, click a category to spin out its sources, click a source to open it. The Find, zoom, Fit and Collapse controls work as in the flow chart.

CHAPTER 6

Source list, lines of enquiry and flags

The readable list of every source, with a one-line description of what many of them give you.

- 1 Click **Source list** in the menu, or click a line of enquiry in the side panel.
- 2 The page title shows the question for that line of enquiry; categories are listed below with their sources.
- 3 Use **Filter all 696 sources** (top right) to search every category by name, site or topic, e.g. "sanctions", "tiktok", "container".
- 4 Guidance notes (grey boxes) give practical advice for the category, e.g. OpSec warnings or search tips.

The screenshot shows the Investigation Desk interface. On the left is a sidebar with a menu for 'Investigation Desk' and various tools. The main area is titled 'Source list' and shows a search bar with a selector and a list of sources. The 'Person' line of enquiry is selected, showing a list of sources categorized by tool type (T, D, R, L, F) and a 'Social Networks' section with various tools like Social Searcher, Social Blade, and myOSINT bookmarklets.

Source list for the Person line of enquiry.

Flags next to sources

FLAG	MEANING	WHAT TO DO
T	Tool to install or run	Software or a command-line tool (usually on GitHub). Install only on an approved machine.
D	Google dork	A ready-made advanced search query.
R	Free login needed	Use an approved research account, never a personal one.
L	Law enforcement / government only	Access through your agency, NCB or liaison channel.
F	Free for verified police	A commercial service that is free once you verify with an official email or ID.

A	May alert the subject	The platform may show the subject that you looked (e.g. LinkedIn), or it involves contact. Think before you click.
P	Privacy / legal caution	E.g. facial recognition, or uploads that become visible to others. Check legal approval first.
NEW	Added in the latest review	Sources added or updated in September 2026.
LE+ / ★	Law-enforcement category	Categories added for police and customs work (maritime, customs, drugs, sanctions, request portals, etc.).

Only free sources

Paid services are deliberately excluded. Some sites have a free tier with limits (marked in their description), and some need a free account (R).

CHAPTER 7

World ports and UN/LOCODE codes

Find any commercial port and its code, by country, name or code.

- 1 Click **World ports** in the menu. It opens on the last country you used (Belgium the first time).
- 2 In **Country**, start typing a country name and pick it from the list.
- 3 In **Port name or code**, type a name ("Guayaquil") or a code ("ECGYE"). A code search looks in every country.
- 4 Use **Harbour size** to show only Large, Medium, Small or Very small ports. Larger ports are listed first.
- 5 Tick **Also show all UN/LOCODE port locations** to add small harbours, river and inland ports that have a port code but are not in the commercial index.

The screenshot shows the Investigation Desk interface. On the left is a sidebar with a menu including 'Flow chart', 'Web map', 'World ports' (selected), 'HS codes', 'Case playbooks', 'Suspect profile', 'Toolbox & case log', and 'How to use - legend'. Below the menu is a 'LINES OF ENQUIRY' section with categories like 'Person', 'Communications', 'Goods, travel & transport', 'Money & companies', 'Digital infrastructure', 'Places & media', and 'By country'. The main area has a top navigation bar with tabs: 'Flow chart', 'Web map', 'Source list', 'World ports' (active), 'HS codes', 'Playbooks', 'Suspect profile', 'Toolbox', and 'Help'. Below this is a search bar with a placeholder 'ANY SELECTOR' and a text input field containing 'Paste a selector: name, @handle, email, +32..., domain, IP, MSCU1234566, IMO 9074729, wallet, hash...'. Below the search bar is a row of filters: 'Try', 'MSCU1234566', 'IMO 9074729', 'TRON wallet', '+32 470 12 34 56', 'example.com', and 'Jan Peeters'. Below this is a row of icons: 'T Local tool', 'D Dork', 'R Free login', 'LE / gov only', 'F Free for police', 'NEW Added Sept 2026', 'A May alert subject', and 'P Privacy / legal'. The main content area is titled 'MARITIME REFERENCE' and 'World ports & UN/LOCODE port codes'. It contains a description: '3,802 commercial seaports from the NGA World Port Index, plus 14,700 further UN/LOCODE port locations (small harbours, river and inland ports). Pick a country or search by port name or code.' Below this are three input fields: 'Country' (set to 'Belgium'), 'Port name or code' (placeholder 'e.g. Antwerp or BEANR'), and 'Harbour size' (radio buttons for 'All' (selected), 'Large', 'Medium', 'Small', 'Very small'). There is also a checkbox 'Also show all UN/LOCODE port locations'. Below the inputs is a section '7 ports in Belgium' with a 'Copy list' and 'Export CSV' button. The table below shows the results:

PORT	UN/LOCODE	SIZE	TYPE / NOTES	LOCATION
Antwerpen Antwerp; Anvers	BEANR	Large	River (Tide Gates) first port of entry North Sea; North Atlantic Ocean	51.217, 4.400 Map · Sea chart · Satellite
Ghent	BEGNE	Medium	Canal or Lake first port of entry North Sea; North Atlantic Ocean	51.067, 3.733 Map · Sea chart · Satellite
Zeebrugge	BEZEE	Medium	Coastal (Breakwater) first port of entry North Sea; North Atlantic Ocean	51.333, 3.200 Map · Sea chart · Satellite
Bruxelles Brussels	BEBRU	Small	River (Tide Gates) first port of entry North Sea; North Atlantic Ocean	50.867, 4.350 Map · Sea chart · Satellite
Oostende	BEOST	Small	River (Tide Gates)	51.233, 2.917

The seven World Port Index ports of Belgium with codes, size, type and map links.

What each row shows

- **Port** and other known names.
- **UN/LOCODE**: click the code to copy it. A code marked ≈ was matched by name and should be confirmed.
- **Size** and **type** (river, coastal breakwater, canal...), whether it is a **first port of entry**, container facilities, and the sea area.
- **Location**: coordinates with links to the map, a nautical chart (OpenSeaMap) and satellite view.

Copy list and **Export CSV** save the ports currently shown, e.g. for a risk-profiling spreadsheet.

Sources

NGA World Port Index (Pub. 150, April 2025 edition, US government, public domain): 3,802 commercial seaports in 193 countries. UNECE UN/LOCODE (release 2024-2): 14,700 further locations with the "port" function. About 430 index ports have no official code and show "none assigned".

Investigation Desk

LE OSINT FRAMEWORK

Flow chart

Web map

World ports

HS codes

Case playbooks

Suspect profile

Toolbox & case log

How to use - legend

LINES OF ENQUIRY

Person

Who is this person?

124 sources

Communications

Who are they talking to, and where?

56 sources

Goods, travel & transport

Where is the shipment, vessel, vehicle or traveller?

126 sources

Money & companies

Where is the money and who owns what?

53 sources

Digital infrastructure

What is behind this website, IP or file?

87 sources

Places & media

Where and when was this taken?

72 sources

By country

Country, location, people, related facts

57 sources

Flow chartWeb mapSource listWorld portsHS codesPlaybooksSuspect profileToolboxHelp

ANY SELECTOR Paste a selector: name, @handle, email, +32..., domain, IP, MSCU1234566, IMO 9074729, wallet, hash... X

Try MSCU1234566IMO 9074729TRON wallet+32 478 12 34 56example.comJan Peeters

T Local toolD DarkR Free loginL LE / gov onlyF Free for policeNEW Added Sept 2026A May alert subjectP Privacy / legal

MARITIME REFERENCE

World ports & UN/LOCODE port codes

3,802 commercial seaports from the NGA World Port Index, plus 14,700 further UN/LOCODE port locations (small harbours, river and inland ports). Pick a country or search by port name or code.

CountryBelgiumPort name or codeECGYE XHarbour sizeAllLargeMediumSmallVery small

☐ Also show all UN/LOCODE port locations

1 port matching ECGYE (all countries)Copy listExport CSV

PORT	UN/LOCODE	SIZE	TYPE / NOTES	LOCATION
Guayaquil	ECGYE	Small	River (Natural) first port of entry South Pacific Ocean	-2.209, -79.883 Map - Sea chart - Satellite

Sources: NGA [World Port Index](#) (Pub. 150, April 2025, public domain) and UNECE [UN/LOCODE](#) (release 2024-2). A code marked = was matched to the port by name and should be confirmed. The ISO 6346 / BIC and container tools are in the Toolbox.

Searching a code finds the port in any country.

CHAPTER 8

HS code finder

All chapters, headings and subheadings of the Harmonized System, with enforcement labels.

Search and browse

- **By code:** type 0803 or 2939.72. You see the code with its chapter and heading above, and subheadings below.
- **By words:** type "bananas" or "acetic anhydride". Several words must all match. The descriptions use customs wording ("fish; frozen" rather than "frozen fish").
- **By section:** choose one of the 21 sections (e.g. VI Chemical products).
- **Browse:** the page opens on the 97 chapters. Click **Show headings →** and **Show subheadings →**; use the trail above the table to go back.

The screenshot shows the 'Investigation Desk' interface with the 'HS codes' tab selected. The search bar contains 'acetic anhydride'. Below the search bar, there are filters for 'Section' (All sections) and 'Enforcement interest' (All codes). The results show 3 codes matching 'acetic anhydride'. The first code, 2915.24, is highlighted and labeled as a 'Drug precursor'.

CODE	DESCRIPTION	LOOK UP
2915.24 Subheading	Acids; saturated acyclic monocarboxylic acids; acetic anhydride in 2915 Acids; saturated acyclic monocarboxylic acids and their anhydrides, halides, pe... Drug precursor	EU TARIC · EBTI rulings Web search · Seizure news
2916.39 Subheading	Acids; aromatic monocarboxylic acids, and their anhydrides, halides, peroxides, peroxyacids and their derivatives, other than benzoic acid, its salts and esters, benzoyl peroxide and benzoyl chloride, phenylacetic acid and its salts in 2916 Acids; unsaturated acyclic monocarboxylic, cyclic monocarboxylic, their anhydri...	EU TARIC · EBTI rulings Web search · Seizure news
2918.91 Subheading	Acids; carboxylic acids, with additional oxygen function (not alcohol, phenol, aldehyde or ketone) and their anhydrides, halides, peroxides and peroxyacids; 2,4,5-T (ISO) (2,4,5-trichlorophenoxyacetic acid), its salts and esters.	EU TARIC · EBTI rulings Web search · Seizure news

Searching "acetic anhydride" finds subheading 2915.24 with its Drug precursor label.

Enforcement labels

LABEL	COVERS
Drug precursor	Acetic anhydride, phenylacetone (P2P), PMK and safrole family, ephedrine and pseudoephedrine, fentanyl precursors (ANPP, NPP), lysergic acid, potassium permanganate and similar.
Narcotic / controlled plant	Cocaine and ecgonine, opium alkaloids, amphetamine and metamphetamine, coca leaf, poppy straw, cannabis/hemp.
Arms & ammunition	Chapter 93.

Excise goods	Tobacco and alcohol.
Frequent cover load	Goods often reported as cover loads in cocaine seizures: bananas, pineapples and avocados, citrus, coffee, cocoa, timber, ceramic tiles, frozen fish and shrimp, sugar, frozen fruit and vegetables.
High value / laundering	Gold, diamonds, jewellery, banknotes and securities.
Medicines	Medicinal products (falsified medicines, diversion).

Click a label to show only codes with that label. For each code: click to copy; **EU TARIC** opens EU duties and measures (8- and 10-digit codes); **EBTI rulings** opens binding tariff decisions; **Web search** and **Seizure news** search Google for the code. **Copy list** / **Export CSV** save the current view.

Labels are risk pointers, not legal classifications

The precursor and narcotic labels come from matching chemical names in the official descriptions; the cover-load label reflects general seizure reporting. Always check the official lists and your national tariff. Data: WCO HS 2022 via UN Comtrade (public domain). HS 2028 enters into force on 1 January 2028.

CHAPTER 9

Case playbooks

Step-by-step guides for common case types, each step linked to the right sources and tools.

The screenshot shows the 'Investigation Desk' interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: Flow chart, Web map, World ports, HS codes, Case playbooks (highlighted), Suspect profile, Toolbox & case log, and How to use - legend. Below this is a 'LINES OF ENQUIRY' section with categories like Person, Communications, Goods, travel & transport, Money & companies, Digital infrastructure, Places & media, and By country, each with a source count. The main area has a top navigation bar with tabs: Flow chart, Web map, Source list, World ports, HS codes, Playbooks (selected), Suspect profile, Toolbox, and Help. Below the tabs is a search bar with the text 'ANY SELECTOR' and a placeholder 'Paste a selector: name, @handle, email, +32..., domain, IP, MSCU1234566, IMO 9074729, wallet, hash...'. Below the search bar is a 'Try' section with filters: MSCU1234566, IMO 9074729, TRON wallet, +32 470 12 34 56, example.com, Jan Peeters, and a row of icons for Local tool, Dork, Free login, LE / gov only, Free for police, NEW Added Sept 2026, May alert subject, and Privacy / legal. The main content area is titled 'CASE PLAYBOOKS' and 'Pick the kind of case you are working'. It displays eight case playbook cards: Drugs concealed in a container, Suspect's online footprint, Online fraud / fake webshop / phishing, Crypto payments and money laundering, Missing or wanted person, Firearms trafficking, Human trafficking and exploitation, and Vessel of interest. Each card includes a brief description and the number of phases and steps.

The eight playbooks.

PLAYBOOK	USE WHEN
Drugs concealed in a container	A seizure, risk hit or intelligence on a container, consignment or trader.
Suspect's online footprint	You have a name, phone, email or handle and need to know who the person is online.
Online fraud / fake webshop / phishing	A victim report about a fake shop, investment platform or phishing site.
Crypto payments and money laundering	A wallet address appears in a seizure, a phone, an advert or a ransom note.
Missing or wanted person	Locating a missing person or a fugitive.
Firearms trafficking	Online sale of weapons or parts, or a seized firearm.
Human trafficking and exploitation	Indicators of sexual or labour exploitation, or suspicious adverts.
Vessel of interest	A vessel suspected of carrying drugs, arms, migrants or sanctioned goods.

Working through a playbook

- 1 Click a playbook card. The steps are grouped in phases (e.g. Verify the shipment → Examine the traders → Context and follow-up).

- Each step says **what to do** and **why** (what it gives you), with buttons for the sources to use. Dashed buttons open a Toolbox tool or the Suspect profile.
- Tick each step when done. Ticks are remembered in your browser; **Reset ticks** clears them.

The screenshot displays the Investigation Desk LE OSINT Framework interface. On the left is a dark sidebar with navigation options: Flow chart, Web map, World ports, HS codes, Case playbooks (highlighted), Suspect profile, Toolbox & case log, and How to use - legend. Below these are 'LINES OF ENQUIRY' categories: Person (124 sources), Communications (56 sources), Goods, travel & transport (126 sources), Money & companies (53 sources), Digital infrastructure (87 sources), Places & media (72 sources), and By country (57 sources). The main panel has a top navigation bar with tabs: Flow chart, Web map, Source list, World ports, HS codes, Playbooks (active), Suspect profile, Toolbox, and Help. Below the tabs is a search bar labeled 'ANY SELECTOR' with a placeholder text and a search icon. A row of selectors is shown: MSCU1234566, IMO 9074729, TRON wallet, +32 478 12 34 56, example.com, and Jan Peeters. Below this is a row of tool icons: Local tool, Dork, Free login, LE / gov only, Free for police, NEW, Added Sept 2026, May alert subject, and Privacy / legal. The main content area is titled 'PLAYBOOK' and 'Drugs concealed in a container' with a subtitle 'A seizure, a risk hit or intelligence on a specific container, consignment or trader.' and a 'Reset ticks' button. The first phase is 'Verify the shipment' with three tasks: 1. Check the container number is genuine (ISO 6346 check digit) and identify the owner / lessor prefix. 2. Track the container on the carrier's site: route, transshipment ports, dwell times, empty-return date. 3. Identify the vessel(s) and check AIS history for gaps, loitering or unscheduled stops. Each task has a checkbox and associated source buttons. The second phase is 'Examine the traders'.

The container playbook, phase 1.

Suspect profile

Build an open-source profile of one subject: from what you know, to where to look, to a report.

SP Subject Profiler
Build an open-source profile of a suspect, one lead at a time.

Report **Save file** **Open file** **New subject**

OpSec Search only from an approved, non-attributable environment. Links marked **A** can alert the subject or log your visit. Links marked **P** carry legal restrictions (e.g. facial recognition). Your authority decides what you may search, not the tool.

This is a fictional example subject so you can see how the page works. Start your own with **New subject**.

Intelligence gaps 0 confirmed · 7 partly known · 3 open

Confirmed identity Partly known Full name, date of birth, photo, aliases. Is this the right person? Data in file	Current whereabouts Partly known Home address, work, places visited, country of residence. Data in file	Contact details Partly known Phone numbers and email addresses in use now. Data in file	Online presence Partly known Social media, messaging handles, forums, marketplaces. Data in file	Associates & family Open Partners, relatives, co-offenders, frequent contacts.
Vehicles & travel Partly known Cars, plates, flights, border crossings, travel patterns. Data in file	Money, companies & assets Partly known Directorships, businesses, property, crypto, lifestyle vs income. Data in file	Legal exposure Open Wanted notices, sanctions, court cases, gazette entries.	Lifestyle & routine Partly known Gym, clubs, check-ins, posting times, habits. 1 finding	Risk & weapons Open Violence, firearms, dogs, counter-surveillance awareness.

1 Subject file
 Enter what you already know. Press Enter after each phone, email, handle etc. Everything saves automatically in this browser.

2 Where to look
 Searches built from the subject file, with the value already filled in. Start with the leads that fill your biggest gaps.

CASE

Case reference: Officer:

IDENTITY

Full name:

Where to look

Searches built from the subject file, with the value already filled in. Start with the leads that fill your biggest gaps.

All leads **Full name** **Alias** **Phone** **Email** **Username** **Address** **Vehicle**

Company **Country sources** **Legal, routine & risk**

FULL NAME Jan Peeters

Look for: confirmation of identity (photos, age, city), **social media accounts**, family members, employer, **company**

Top of the suspect profile: OpSec reminder and the ten intelligence gaps. The page opens with a fictional example subject.

1. Intelligence gaps

Ten requirements of a subject profile: confirmed identity, current whereabouts, contact details, online presence, associates & family, vehicles & travel, money/companies/assets, legal exposure, lifestyle & routine, and risk & weapons. Each shows **Open**, **Partly known** or **Confirmed**. It updates automatically as you add data and findings, and you can set it yourself.

2. Subject file (step 1)

Enter the case reference, officer and everything already known: name, aliases, date of birth, nationality, country of residence, city, photo URLs, phones, emails, usernames, websites, addresses, vehicles, companies, wallets and associates. For fields that take several values, type one and press **Enter**. Everything saves automatically in your browser.

3. Where to look (step 2)

For every detail you entered, a card lists searches with the value already filled in. Each card says **Look for** (what that source can reveal) and **Pivot** (what new lead it can give). The subject's countries add national registers, gazettes, courts and marketplaces; an "Always check" card covers wanted notices, sanctions, routine and weapons risk.

4. Findings and pivots (step 3)

Log each finding with its source URL and the gap it answers; it is time-stamped in UTC. If the finding is a new identifier (e.g. a Telegram handle), choose its type and value: it is added to the subject file and its searches appear in step 2.

5. Report, save and open

- **Report** creates a plain-text profile summary; **Copy report** puts it on the clipboard for your case file.
- **Save file** stores the whole profile as a .json file; **Open file** loads it again. Keep one file per subject.
- **New subject** clears the page (click twice to confirm).

1 Subject file
Enter what you already know. Press Enter after each phone, email, handle etc. Everything saves automatically in this browser.

CASE

Case reference
EXAMPLE-0001

Officer
Your name

IDENTITY

Full name
Jan Peeters

Aliases / nicknames
JP Kiel x e.g. Johnny D

Date of birth
1988

Nationality
Belgium

Country of residence
Belgium

City / area
Antwerp

Photo URLs (for reverse image search)
https://.../photo.jpg

CONTACT & ONLINE

Phone numbers
+32 478 12 34 56 x +32 470 12 34 56

Email addresses
jan.peeters88@gmail.com x name@example.com

2 Where to look
Searches built from the subject file, with the value already filled in. Start with the leads that fill your biggest gaps.

All leads

Full name

Alias

Phone

Email

Username

Address

Vehicle

Company

Country sources

Legal, routine & risk

FULL NAME Jan Peeters

Look for: confirmation of identity (photos, age, city), social media accounts, family members, employer, company directorships, news coverage, court or sanctions entries.

Google exact name + city Pages that mention the full name

Google name + birth year Filters out namesakes

Google social media Profiles indexed by Google

LinkedIn via Google Employer and CV without alerting the subject

Google documents CVs, lists, minutes, invoices

Google News Press coverage, previous cases

Facebook search Profiles, friends, photos

Webmii People search across the web

Yandex Stronger for Eastern Europe / Russia

OpenCorporates officers Directorships worldwide

OpenSanctions Sanctions, PEPs, wanted lists

ICIJ Offshore Leaks Offshore companies & trusts

OCCRP Aleph Leaks, registries, court records

Interpol Red Notices Search by name on the page

EU Most Wanted Europe's most wanted fugitives

Pivot: Usernames, photos, employer, relatives' names, companies ... add them to the file.

ALIAS JP Kiel

Look for: the alias used as a handle, in forums, music, gang or marketplace contexts.

Google exact alias

WhatsMyName (as username) 600+ sites

Instagram hashtagan

TikTok search

Subject file (left) and Where to look (right).

Toolbox and case log

Offline tools that run in your browser. Nothing you enter or choose is uploaded.

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES
Case log	Records case reference, officer, URL, description and UTC time; optionally hashes a saved file (MD5 and SHA-256). Export to CSV or JSON.
File hash	MD5, SHA-1 and SHA-256 of one or more files or text. Search a hash on VirusTotal instead of uploading the file.
EXIF viewer	Camera, date and GPS metadata of a photo, with map links. Social media usually strip this data.
Container / IMO / VIN / IBAN	Check digits for ISO 6346 container numbers (with owner code), IMO numbers, MMSI flag code (MID), VINs and IBANs. Catches typos and fabricated numbers on manifests and payment documents.
Crypto address	Identifies the blockchain from the address format and links to the right explorer, scam reports and sanctions lists.
Phone & IMEI	Country (about 180 dialling codes), mobile or fixed line by prefix, every format to search for; IMEI check digit and model code (TAC).
Coordinates	Decimal ↔ degrees-minutes-seconds, with links to Google Maps, Street View, OpenStreetMap, Bing, Yandex, Apple Maps, Mapillary, SunCalc and Copernicus.
Username permutations	Generates the usual username and email patterns from a first name, last name and year.
Dork builder	Builds advanced search queries (exact phrase, site, file type, dates...) and runs them on Google, Bing, DuckDuckGo and Yandex.
Time & snowflake IDs	Converts Unix, millisecond, Windows FILETIME and ISO times across time zones; decodes the creation time hidden in X/Twitter and Discord IDs.
Encode / decode	Base64, URL, hex, ROT13, reverse, and defang/refang URLs for safe reporting.

Case log

Record each capture with a UTC timestamp and a hash of the saved file. Entries stay in this browser only. Export to CSV or JSON at the end of each session and attach it to your case file.

Case reference

e.g. BXL-2026-0412

Officer

Name / badge number

URL captured

https://...

Saved file (optional, hashed locally)

Choose File

No file chosen

What was seen / action taken

e.g. Screenshot of Telegram channel post offering 5 kg, posted 27/09 21:14 UTC

Add entry

Export CSV

Export JSON

Copy CSV

Clear log

1 entry

UTC	CASE / OFFICER	URL	DESCRIPTION	HASH	
2026-09-28T08:41:07Z	EXAMPLE-2026-014 Example Officer	https://www.vesselfinder.com/vessels?name=EXAMPLE	Screenshot of vessel page, AIS gap 12-15 Sep vessel_page.png (184233 bytes)	(example row: delete once you add real entries)	Remove

The case log.

Using the case log well

- 1 Enter your case reference and name once; they are remembered.
- 2 For each capture: paste the URL, describe what you saw, optionally attach the saved screenshot or file (it is hashed locally), and click **Add entry**.
- 3 From a run sheet, the **Log** button adds the search with one click.
- 4 At the end of every session: **Export CSV** (laptop version) or **Copy CSV** (online preview), and attach it to the case file.

The log lives in your browser

Clearing browser data, using a private window or switching browser or computer removes it. Export regularly.

Operational security, legal and evidential rules

Good OSINT protects the investigation, the subject's rights and the evidence.

Operational security

- Work from an approved, non-attributable research environment (dedicated machine, virtual machine or managed browser). Never use personal accounts or devices.
- Use approved research accounts for sites marked **R**. Some platforms show the subject who viewed them (flag **A**).
- Do not contact the subject. Opening a WhatsApp chat page is passive; sending a message is contact.
- Search a file's hash before uploading it anywhere. Public sandboxes and some image tools make uploads visible to others (flag **P**).
- Do not paste case material into public translation or AI services unless your agency has approved them.
- Public archiving (Wayback "Save Page Now", archive.today) leaves a trace the subject can find.

Legal

- Your legal authority decides what you may search; collect only what is necessary and proportionate (ECHR Article 8; in the EU, the Law Enforcement Directive 2016/680).
- Facial recognition is restricted or prohibited in many jurisdictions (EU AI Act). Get legal approval first.
- Breach data and leaked material: follow your agency's policy on their use and record the source and date.
- Subscriber data, logs and content held by platforms require legal process: see the **LE Request Portals** category and Europol SIRIUS.

Evidence

- For every capture record: URL, date and time (UTC), what you saw, who captured it, the tool used and a hash of the saved file (the case log does this).
- Capture the whole page and the context (profile, date of posting), not only the relevant line. Video-record dynamic content.
- Verify every finding with a second, independent source before relying on it.
- The Berkeley Protocol on Digital Open Source Investigations (linked in Legal & Ethics) is a good reference for method and documentation.

Sharing, updating and maintaining the framework

Sharing with colleagues

- **Link:** send <https://glretief-ux.github.io/LE-OSINT-Framework/>. It opens in any browser without an account.
- **File:** email **LE-OSINT-Framework.zip**. Mail filters often block raw .html attachments; a zip usually passes. If it is blocked, use OneDrive / SharePoint or your agency's file-transfer service.

Switching on the website (administrator, once)

- 1 Open the repository on GitHub → **Settings** → **Pages**.
- 2 Source: **Deploy from a branch**, branch **main**, folder **/ (root)** → **Save**. The site is live about a minute later.

Adding or correcting a source

All sources are in one text file, `data/links.js`, one line per source:

Site name | `https://example.com/search?q={q}` | R | name,org | What it gives you

- `{q}` marks where the selector goes; the fourth column lists the selector types the search accepts.
- Flags go in the third column: T D R L F A P (and N for new).
- Edit the file on GitHub (pencil icon) and commit. The online version updates within a minute. For the laptop file, run `python tools/build_standalone.py` or ask the administrator for a new file.
- Please do not add paid services.

Keeping links working

A GitHub Action checks every link each Monday and opens an issue listing broken ones. To run it now: **Actions** → **Weekly link check** → **Run workflow**. Review the source list at least once a quarter; free OSINT tools change quickly.

Data updates

- World Port Index: new editions are published by NGA a few times a year.
- UN/LOCODE: two releases a year (UNECE).
- HS: the 2028 edition takes effect on 1 January 2028.

Troubleshooting and frequently asked questions

PROBLEM	SOLUTION
I don't see World ports / HS codes / a new feature.	You are using an older copy. Reload the online page (<code>Ctrl</code> + <code>F5</code>) or replace your laptop file with the latest version.
A shared Claude link shows "Couldn't load this Artifact".	Use the GitHub Pages link instead, or the laptop file.
The selector type is wrong (e.g. a company name treated as a person).	Click the type chip on the left of the search bar and choose the right type.
A search opens the site's home page instead of results.	That source does not accept this type of selector, or no selector is entered. Search on the site itself.
A link is broken or the site has changed.	Report it to the administrator, who corrects <code>data/links.js</code> . The weekly link check also catches most of these.
Export CSV / Save file does nothing.	Downloads are blocked in the online preview inside Claude. Use Copy instead, or the laptop / GitHub Pages version.
My case log or profile disappeared.	They are stored in the browser. Clearing browser data, private windows or another browser start empty. Export regularly and keep profile files.
The flow chart or web map text is tiny.	Zoom in with the mouse wheel or <code>+</code> , or use the Source list.
My network blocks GitHub or a source.	Use the laptop file for the tool itself; for blocked sources, use your agency's approved research environment.
Can I add my own national sources?	Yes. Add lines under "Country Sources" in <code>data/links.js</code> (chapter 13).

Quick reference

Workflow in six steps

- 1 Confirm authority and open an approved research environment.
- 2 Paste the selector; check the type chip.
- 3 Work the run sheet or a playbook; tick as you go.
- 4 Pivot: add new identifiers to the suspect profile.
- 5 Log and hash every capture.
- 6 Export the case log and profile report to the case file.

Flags

T tool · D dork · R free login · L LE/gov only · F free for police · A may alert subject · P privacy/legal · NEW added Sept 2026

Useful keys

Enter in the search bar opens the run sheet · Esc clears it · Enter adds a value in the suspect profile · mouse wheel zooms the maps.

Where to find...

Container tracking	Search bar or Goods › Maritime & Containers
Port code	World ports
Commodity code	HS codes
Company directors	Money & companies; By country
Wallet tracing	Money › Digital Currency; crypto playbook
Photo location	Places & media; Toolbox › EXIF, Coordinates
Platform data request	Procedure › LE Request Portals
Genuine ID documents	Person › Identity & Travel Documents (PRADO)
Sanctions / wanted	Money › Sanctions; Person › Wanted & Missing

Data sources

Source list compiled and reviewed September 2026. Ports: NGA World Port Index, Pub. 150 (April 2025, public domain); UNECE UN/LOCODE release 2024-2. HS codes: WCO Harmonized System 2022 via UN Comtrade (public domain). Listed websites are third-party services and are not endorsed; availability and terms change. Verify every finding with a second source.